

Unit 3 Assessment

Cartographer Skills Assessment

Grade 3 Social Studies | Basics of Maps | Weeks 7–10

Name: _____

Date: _____

Part A: Knowledge Check

Choose the best answer.

1. What does a map's title tell you?

- A. How old the map is
- B. What the map is about or what place it shows
- C. Who drew the map
- D. How big the map is

2. A compass rose shows:

- A. How far apart places are
- B. What symbols mean
- C. Directions like north, south, east, and west
- D. Population numbers

3. What does a map legend explain?

- A. The distance between places
- B. The direction of north
- C. What the symbols and colors on the map mean
- D. The year the map was made

4. If a map scale says 1 inch = 100 miles, how far apart are two places that are 3 inches apart on the map?

- A. 100 miles
- B. 200 miles
- C. 300 miles
- D. 400 miles

5. Which type of map shows country borders and capital cities?

- A. Physical map
- B. Elevation map
- C. Political map
- D. Population map

6. Why does Greenland look bigger than it really is on a flat map?

- A. Greenland is actually the biggest country
- B. Flat maps stretch places near the North and South Poles
- C. The map was drawn wrong
- D. Globes make Greenland look too small

7. Match each map type to what it shows.

_____ Physical map	A. Where people live (dots or shading)
_____ Elevation map	B. Rivers, mountains, and landforms
_____ Population map	C. Height of land (green to brown color layers)

Part B: Map Task

Read the description. Then answer.

Map description: A map of a small island. It has a title that says "Treasure Island." A compass rose shows north pointing up. The legend shows a tree symbol = forest, a blue line = river, and a red X = treasure. The scale bar shows 1 inch = 2 miles. The treasure is about 3 inches from the beach on the map.

8. About how far is the treasure from the beach in real life?

- A. 2 miles
- B. 4 miles
- C. 6 miles
- D. 8 miles

9. Name three map elements this map includes. For each one, explain what it tells the reader.

Part C: Constructed Response

10. What is the difference between a flat map and a globe? Give one advantage of each.

Part D: Virtue Reflection

11. The lesson on creating maps connects to the virtue of responsibility. Why is responsibility important for a mapmaker? What could go wrong if a mapmaker is not responsible?

Section	Points
Part A: Knowledge Check (Q1–7)	9 pts
Part B: Map Task (Q8–9)	7 pts
Part C: Constructed Response (Q10)	4 pts
Part D: Virtue Reflection (Q11)	4 pts
Total	24 pts

Unit 3 Assessment — Answer Key

Cartographer Skills Assessment

Part A (9 pts)

1. B — What the map is about or place it shows (1 pt)
2. C — Directions (1 pt)
3. C — What symbols and colors mean (1 pt)
4. C — 300 miles (1 pt)
5. C — Political map (1 pt)
6. B — Flat maps stretch places near the poles (1 pt)
7. Matching (3 pts): Physical = B; Elevation = C; Population = A

Part B (7 pts)

8. C — 6 miles (3 in x 2 mi/in) (1 pt)

9. (6 pts) **Secure:** Names 3 elements (title, compass rose, legend, scale) and explains each. **Developing:** Names 3 but explanations weak. **Beginning:** Fewer than 3 or no explanations.

Part C (4 pts)

10. **Secure:** Flat map = can see whole world, easy to carry; globe = true shape, no distortion. **Developing:** States difference but only one advantage. **Beginning:** Vague or no advantages.

Part D (4 pts)

11. **Secure:** Responsibility = including all elements (title, scale, legend, compass rose) so readers can trust the map. Without them, people get lost or misunderstand. **Developing:** General connection. **Beginning:** Names virtue only.